

Lecture Outline Intro: The United States at 1850

1850 United States is a continental nation

The Native American Landscape

a legacy of agriculture, towns, and landscape

- centered landscapes versus bounded territories
- highly productive agricultural systems – three sisters: corn, beans, and squash
- permanent settlements and town building
- sacred landscapes and ceremonial capitals

The Legacy of the European Colonization

Predominance of the Grid in colonial town planning (Greek and Roman precedents)

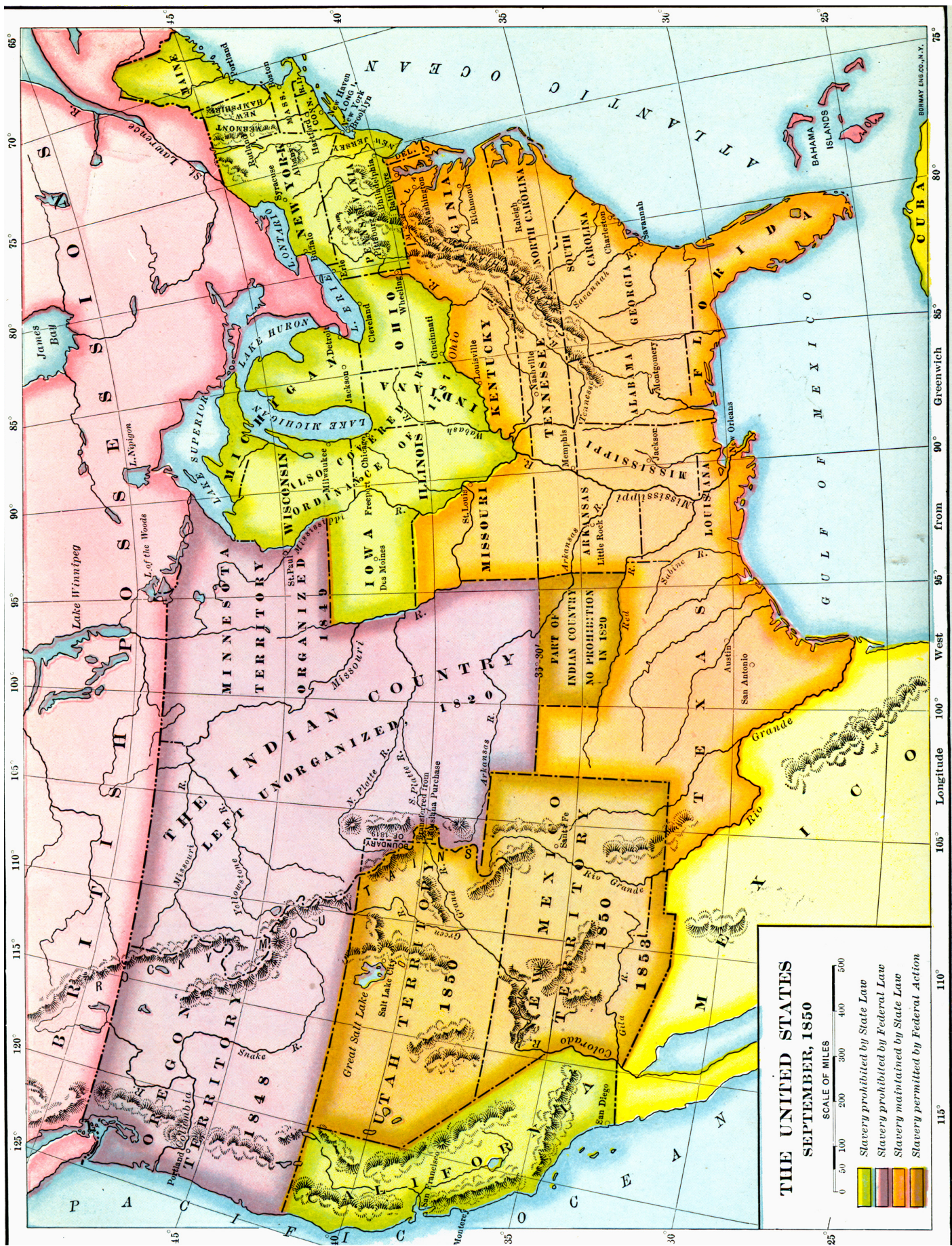
- Town grids with public squares in colonial towns oriented to links for global trade: roads and ports (British, French, Spanish, Russian, Dutch)
- The influential example of colonial Philadelphia, 1682
the urban grid, the town lot, and green squares

The United States of America & the Grid

- the problem of the colonial *metes and bounds* surveying system
- Land Ordinance of 1785 – accelerating surveying and settlement
the rectangular survey system or Public Land Survey System (PLSS)
- Grid carries on for new settlements of the American nation even before implementation of PLSS eg. Marietta, Ohio, 1788
- PLSS administered by the General Land Office in Washington DC
and branch offices
- The Grid forms default scheme for town and land planning, rigorously imposed

U.S. TERRITORIAL ACQUISITIONS





The United States, September, 1850

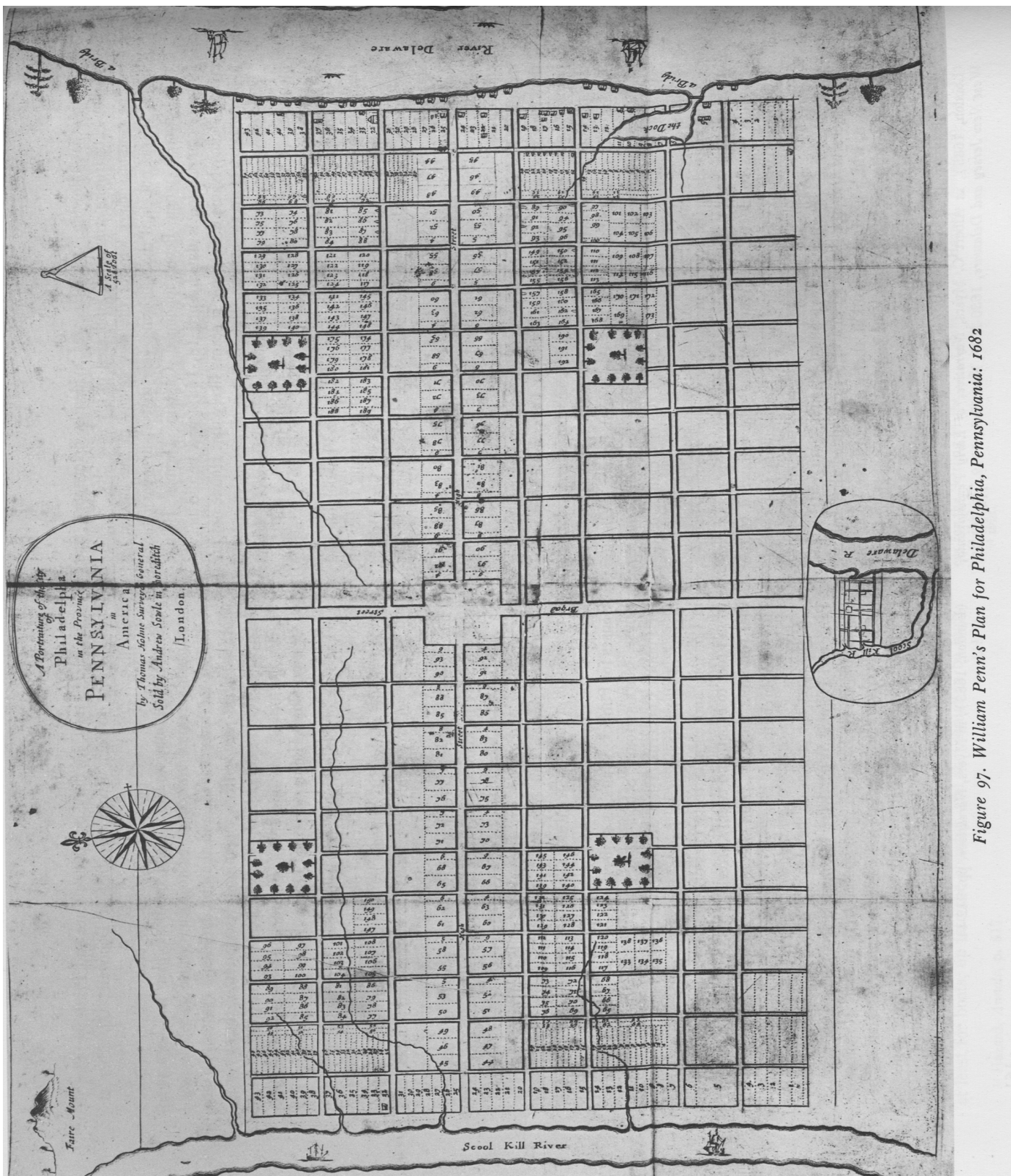
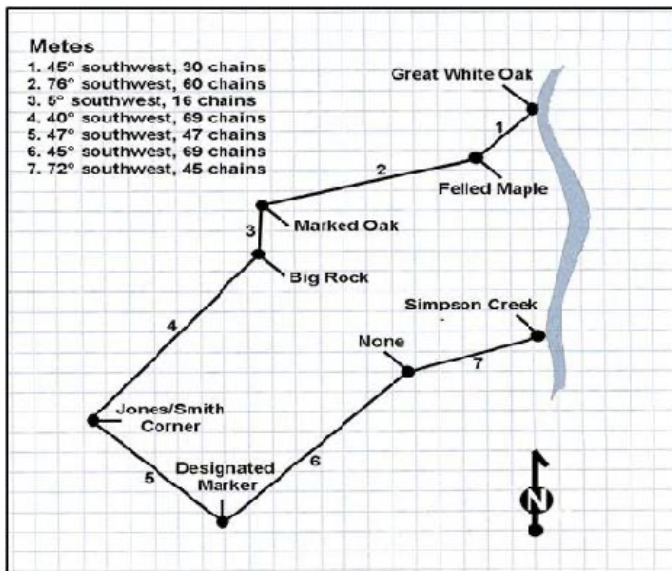
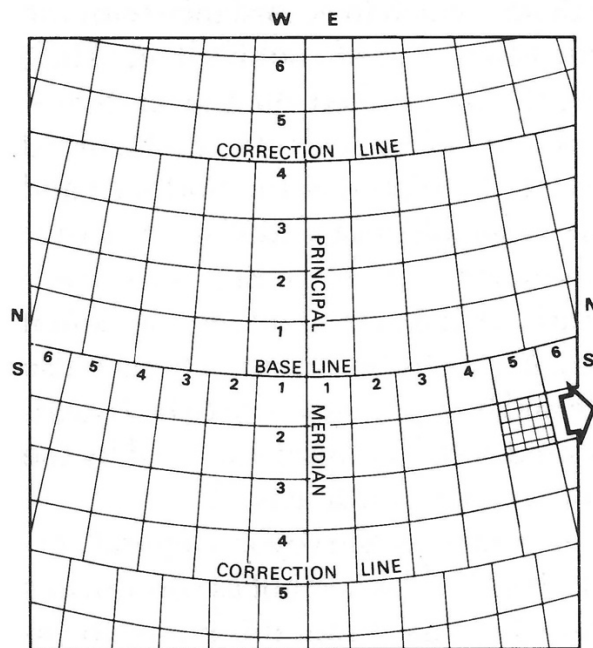


Figure 97. William Penn's Plan for Philadelphia, Pennsylvania: 1682



Metes and Bounds survey system



TOWNSHIP 2 SOUTH, RANGE 5 EAST (T.2S, R.5E)

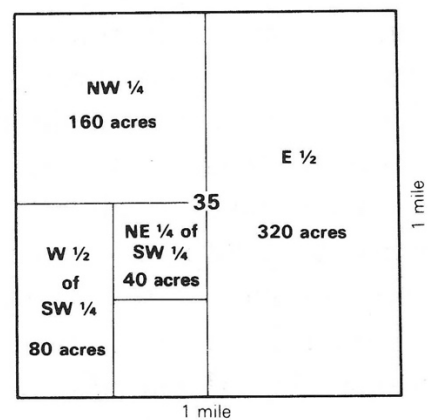
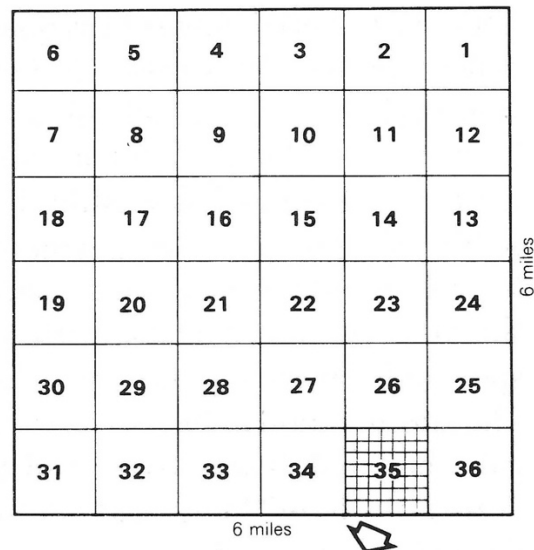


Figure 4-3. The U.S. Rectangular Survey System. After 1796, each township was numbered with reference to a baseline and principal meridian and subdivided into 36 sections, always numbered as shown. Tracts sold by the government decreased in size between 1796 and 1832 from 640 to 40 acres.

